

Opportunity For COMPONENTS INDUSTRY In Telangana's SpaceTech Framework

The state of Telangana's new policy getting ready, SpaceTech Framework, holds a great promise for the development of specialised components required for the high-tech sector. The state government is going all out to support the sector. Read on to find out how, and the new opportunities that are likely to arise as a result

*Telangana government launches SpaceTech Framework on metaverse
(Credit: <https://indiaaheadnews.com>)*



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The state of Telangana introduced a new policy document called SpaceTech Framework online on 18th April. It had virtual participation of ISRO Chairman S. Somnath, Niti Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant, and India's space sector regulator IN-SPACe Chairman Pawan Goenka, along with Telangana's IT Minister KT Rama Rao.

The policy's key focus, as the name suggests, is nurturing space technology industry. However, the policy pays due regard to other related sectors as well, both upstream

and downstream, to enable the high-tech industry. As with any high-tech industry, SpaceTech can only exist with a reliable supply base for the required electronic components.

Synergising the value chain

In the document, the government of Telangana has identified a 'space market value chain,' which includes everything from identifying end users to the upstream manufacturing sub sectors. To enable this value chain, the policy suggests public private partnerships. These partnerships will involve the sharing of expensive high-tech testing and R&D facilities between government institutions and small private players that cannot afford to set up their own.

Some specifically identified institutions in the policy for such a prospective R&D and testing facilities sharing arrangement are Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL) at Hyderabad, International Advanced Research Centre for Powder Metallurgy and New Materials (ARCI), and Defence Research and

Development Organisation (DRDO).

The policy is likely inspired by India's 2020 private space sector reforms. Under the reforms, India's space sector regulatory body IN-SPACe was set up. Among its many other tasks, IN-SPACe is to offer and streamline access to ISRO's infrastructure and testing facilities to India's emerging private space companies. Cooperation and infrastructure sharing across R&D and testing will be a shot in the arm for lowering entry costs and maximising efficiency. However, how seamless would the access to R&D and testing facilities be for the intended MSMEs and startups remains to be seen.

As a broad objective, the policy seeks to attract global investment and partnerships as well as boost space-related manufacturing in the state. This will naturally extend to component and subassembly suppliers too and likely include manufacturers and suppliers that can provide microelectronics and ICs that meet the stringent specifications necessary for the extreme physical condi-